Yangtze and **Mekong** rivers flow in the south and south eastern parts of Asia. **Yangtze** is the longest river in Asia.



River Yangtze

DO YOU KNOW?

The Three Gorges dam has been constructed across the river Yangtze. It is the largest power station dam in the world. It fulfills ten percent of power needs of China.



Climate

Asia exhibits a variety of climate. The northern part of Asia experiences severe long winter and cool summer. **(Winter -37°C** and **Summer 10°C).** Precipitation is in the form of snow **(250 mm to 300 mm)**.The north eastern part of Asia experiences cold winter and warm summer and a moderate rainfall of **50 mm to 250 mm**.

The south, south east and eastern parts of Asia are strongly influenced by monsoon winds. Summer is hot and humid while winter is cool and dry. The summer monsoon winds bring heavy rainfall to India, Bangladesh, Indo-China, Philippines and Southern China **(1500 mm to 2500 mm)**. In India, **Mawsynram (11871 mm)** receives the highest rainfall. So, this place is called the wettest place in the world.

The areas found in and around the equator have uniform climate throughout the year. There is no winter. The average temperature is **27°C** and the mean rainfall is **1270 mm**.

HOTS :

There is no winter in the equatorial region. Why?

The west and central parts of Asia have hot, dry climate. The temperature is very high during the day and very low during the night. Rainfall varies from **25 mm to 200 mm**. The West coastal fringe of Asia (along the Mediterranean Sea) receives **rainfall in winter** and is warm in summer.

Deserts are found along the western part of Asia. The major hot deserts are the **Arabian** (Saudi Arabia) and **Thar** (India and Pakistan) **deserts**. The cold deserts of Asia are **Gobi** and **Taklamakan**. The largest desert in Asia is the Arabian Desert.

Natural Vegetation

Natural vegetation depends upon **rainfall, temperature** and **soil**. As Asia stretches from the equator to poles, all types of vegetation are found here. Some rare species are found in Asia. Such as **Orang-Utan, Komodo Dragon, Giant panda**. The Asian flora and fauna are listed below:

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